

M2S-04: Step 4 — Prepare: Readiness and Pre-Migration

Series: M2S — Managed to SaaS Migration | **Notebook:** 4 of 9 | **Phase:** Upgrade | **Step:** Prepare | **Created:** March 2026 | **Last Updated:** 04/06/2026

With the target architecture designed, it is time to prepare everything needed for migration execution. This step ensures your SaaS tenant is provisioned, identity is configured, ActiveGates are deployed in parallel, and rollback procedures are tested—so that when you flip the switch in Step 5, there are no surprises.

M2S Migration Journey — 3 Phases / 9 Steps

Plan: 1. Discover | 2. Strategize | 3. Design

Upgrade: 4. **Prepare** | 5. Execute | 6. Integrate

Run: 7. Expand | 8. Enable | 9. Optimize

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Prerequisites

Before starting this notebook, you should have:

Requirement	Description
Steps 1–3 completed	Discovery inventory, migration strategy, and target architecture designed
Dynatrace account team contact	For licensing coordination and tenant provisioning
Identity provider access	Admin access to your SAML IdP (Azure Entra, Okta, etc.)
Infrastructure access	Ability to deploy new ActiveGate VMs/instances
Network changes approved	Firewall rules from Design step implemented or in progress
Managed cluster v1.294+	Required for SaaS Upgrade Assistant compatibility

Learning Objectives

By the end of this notebook, you will:

- Understand the licensing considerations for a dual-run migration period
 - Provision and configure a SaaS tenant in the correct region
 - Set up SAML SSO and initial IAM groups and policies
 - Deploy SaaS-connected ActiveGates in parallel with Managed AGs
 - Install and connect the SaaS Upgrade Assistant
 - Recreate network zones in the SaaS tenant
 - Implement a configuration freeze on the Managed environment
 - Document and test a rollback procedure
 - Complete the readiness checklist before proceeding to Execute
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This notebook covers operations **1-3** of the 11-step Order of Operations (see **M2S-02: Step 2 — Strategize**) defined in Step 2:

#	Operation	Status
1	Assess — Inventory current environment	This notebook
2	Provision — SaaS tenant and access (SSO)	This notebook
3	Install — New ActiveGates in parallel	This notebook
4	Migrate — Configuration and integrations	Step 5: Execute
5	Rebuild — Dashboards, zones, alerts	Step 5: Execute
6	Redirect — OneAgents to SaaS	Step 5: Execute
7	Reconnect — Integrations and extensions	Step 6: Integrate
8	Migrate — Remaining config and integrations	Step 6: Integrate
9	Validate — Data flow and performance	Step 9: Optimize
10	Cutover — Full switch to SaaS	Step 9: Optimize
11	Decommission — Managed environment	Step 9: Optimize

1. Licensing and Contract Alignment

Before any technical work begins, coordinate with your Dynatrace account team to ensure licensing covers the migration period.

1.1 Dual-Run Licensing

During migration, both the Managed environment and the SaaS tenant are active simultaneously. This **dual-run period** typically lasts 2–4 weeks, depending on the size and complexity of your environment.

Consideration	Detail
Overlap period	Plan for 2–4 weeks of parallel operation
DPS model	SaaS uses Dynatrace Platform Subscription (DPS)

Consideration	Detail
Managed licensing	Existing Managed license remains active during migration
Budget impact	Account for additional cost during overlap
Account team	Coordinate timing so both licenses are active simultaneously

Important: Do not let the Managed license expire before all agents are migrated. If the Managed license lapses during migration, OneAgents still connected to Managed will stop reporting.

1.2 DPS (Dynatrace Platform Subscription)

SaaS uses the DPS consumption model. Key differences from Managed licensing:

Aspect	Managed	SaaS (DPS)
Billing unit	Host units (HU)	DPS credits
Consumption model	Fixed capacity	Consumption-based
Data retention	Managed by customer	Configurable per data type
Grail storage	N/A (Managed uses Cassandra)	Included in DPS

1.3 Timeline Coordination

Milestone	Action
T-4 weeks	Confirm dual-run licensing with account team
T-2 weeks	SaaS tenant provisioned and accessible
T-1 week	All preparation complete (this notebook)
T-0	Begin agent migration (Step 5)
T+2–4 weeks	Complete migration, decommission Managed

2. SaaS Tenant Provisioning

Your Dynatrace account team provisions the SaaS tenant. You must provide key decisions before provisioning begins.

2.1 Provisioning Decisions

Decision	Options	Impact
Cloud provider	AWS or Azure	Determines underlying infrastructure
Data residency region	US, EU, APAC (specific regions within)	Cannot change after provisioning
Azure Native	Azure Native Dynatrace Service (if applicable)	Simplified billing via Azure Marketplace

Critical: The data residency region is permanent. Confirm your choice with compliance, legal, and security teams before requesting provisioning. Moving to a different region later requires a new tenant and full re-migration.

2.2 Azure Native Dynatrace Service

If your organization uses Azure, consider the Azure Native Dynatrace Service:

Benefit	Detail
Marketplace billing	Dynatrace costs appear on your Azure invoice
Simplified provisioning	Create Dynatrace resources directly in Azure portal
Native integration	Automatic log and metric forwarding from Azure resources
Single sign-on	Leverage existing Azure Entra ID without separate SAML config

2.3 Initial Tenant Configuration

After the tenant is provisioned, configure these baseline settings:

Setting	Location	Value
Timezone	Settings > Preferences	Match your primary operations timezone
Currency	Settings > Preferences	Match your reporting currency
Data retention	Settings > Data privacy > Data retention	Set per data type (logs, metrics, spans)
Session timeout	Account Management > Security	Align with your organization's policy

2.4 Verify Tenant Access

Confirm all migration team members can access the new tenant:

Endpoint	Test
<code>https://{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com</code>	Browser login succeeds
<code>https://{tenant-id}.apps.dynatrace.com</code>	Apps platform loads
<code>https://{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v1/time</code>	API responds with server time

```
# Verify API access
curl -s "https://{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v1/time" \
-H "Authorization: Api-Token {token}" | python3 -m json.tool
```

3. SSO and Identity Setup

SaaS requires SAML 2.0 for single sign-on. If your Managed environment uses LDAP, this is the point where you transition to SAML.

3.1 SAML 2.0 Configuration Requirements

Requirement	Detail
Protocol	SAML 2.0
IdP signing	Must sign the entire SAML message (not just the assertion)
Name ID	Email address format recommended
Attributes	First name, last name, email, groups
SP Entity ID	Provided by Dynatrace during SAML setup
ACS URL	Provided by Dynatrace during SAML setup

Critical: If the IdP signs only the SAML assertion (not the full message), authentication will fail silently. Azure Entra ID signs the full message by default. For other IdPs (Okta, PingFederate, ADFS), verify this setting explicitly.

3.2 Azure Entra ID Configuration

For organizations using Azure Entra ID as their IdP:

Step	Action
1	Create Enterprise Application for Dynatrace SSO
2	Configure SAML settings with SP Entity ID and ACS URL
3	Map attributes: UPN, email, first name, last name
4	Filter group claims to Dynatrace-related groups only
5	Assign users and groups to the application
6	Test SSO login

Warning: Azure Entra has a **150-group limit** per SAML token. If a user belongs to more than 150 groups, the token will contain a group overage claim instead of individual group IDs. Always filter group claims to include only Dynatrace-relevant groups.

3.3 DNS Domain Validation

Dynatrace requires domain validation for SSO:

Step	Action
1	Add your email domain in Dynatrace Account Management
2	Add the provided TXT record to your DNS
3	Wait for DNS propagation (up to 48 hours)
4	Verify domain in Dynatrace Account Management

3.4 Test SSO Login

Before proceeding, verify SSO works end-to-end:

1. Open an incognito/private browser window
2. Navigate to `https://{tenant-id}.apps.dynatrace.com`
3. Click "Sign in with SSO"
4. Authenticate via your IdP
5. Verify you land in the Dynatrace tenant with correct permissions

Tip: Test with at least one user from each IAM group to confirm group-based policy assignment works correctly.

3.5 Initial IAM Groups and Policies

Create the IAM structure designed in Step 3. At minimum:

Group	Policy	Purpose
migration-admins	Account admin + Environment admin	Migration team full access
platform-admins	Environment admin	Day-to-day administration
sre-team	Environment editor	SRE operations access
viewers	Environment viewer	Read-only stakeholders

Note: These are starting groups. Refine IAM after migration is complete in Step 6 (Integrate). The goal here is to have enough access for migration activities.

4. ActiveGate Provisioning

Deploy new SaaS-connected ActiveGates **in parallel** with your existing Managed ActiveGates. This ensures continuous monitoring during migration and provides an easy rollback path.

4.1 Parallel Deployment Strategy

Phase	Managed AGs	SaaS AGs	OneAgents Point To
Pre-migration (now)	Running	Deploying	Managed AGs
During migration	Running	Running	Gradually shifting to SaaS AGs
Post-migration	Decommissioning	Running	SaaS AGs

4.2 ActiveGate Installation

Install ActiveGates connected to the SaaS tenant. Use the sizing from your Design step.

```
# Download ActiveGate installer from SaaS tenant
curl -o Dynatrace-ActiveGate-Linux.sh \
  "https://{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v1/deployment/installer/gateway/unix/latest" \
  -H "Authorization: Api-Token {paas-token}"

# Install with network zone assignment
sudo /bin/sh Dynatrace-ActiveGate-Linux.sh \
  --set-network-zone={zone-name}
```

4.3 Network Zone Assignment

Assign each AG to the correct network zone during installation:

```
# Assign during installation (recommended)
sudo /bin/sh Dynatrace-ActiveGate-Linux.sh --set-network-zone=datacenter-east

# Or assign after installation via custom.properties
# Edit /var/lib/dynatrace/gateway/config/custom.properties
# Add: networkzone = datacenter-east
# Then restart: sudo systemctl restart dynatracegateway
```

4.4 ActiveGate Groups

Create AG groups as designed in Step 3:

Group	Purpose	Configuration
production-routing	Route production OneAgent traffic	Default group for production zones
nonprod-routing	Route non-production traffic	Default group for non-production zones
extensions	Extensions 2.0 execution	Host-based AGs only
synthetic	Private synthetic monitoring	Dedicated synthetic AGs

Reminder: Extensions 2.0 require **host-based** ActiveGates. Kubernetes-based ActiveGates do not support Extensions 2.0.

4.5 Validate AG Connectivity

After deploying each ActiveGate, verify it appears in the SaaS tenant and is healthy.

```
// Verify ActiveGates connected to SaaS tenant
fetch dt.entity.active_gate
| fieldsAdd entity.name, version = toString(softwareVersion)
| fields entity.name, version, networkZone
| sort entity.name asc

// Note: smartscapeNodes ACTIVE_GATE is not yet available on Grail
// Continue using fetch dt.entity.active_gate until Smartscape coverage expands
```

```
// Verify ActiveGate distribution across network zones
fetch dt.entity.active_gate
| summarize agCount = count(), by:{networkZone}
| sort agCount desc

// Note: smartscapeNodes ACTIVE_GATE is not yet available on Grail
// Continue using fetch dt.entity.active_gate until Smartscape coverage
expands
```

4.6 Connectivity Validation Checklist

Check	Command	Expected Result
AG → SaaS	<code>curl -v https://{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com</code> from AG host	HTTP 200
AG appears in tenant	DQL query above returns the AG	AG listed with correct zone
AG version current	Compare version to latest available	Within 1–2 minor versions
AG health	Dynatrace UI > Deployment status	Green / Healthy

5. SaaS Upgrade Assistant Setup

The [SaaS Upgrade Assistant](#) is a Dynatrace app that automates configuration migration from Managed to SaaS. Install and connect it now so it is ready for Step 5 (Execute).

5.1 Prerequisites

Requirement	Detail
Managed cluster version	v1.294 or later
Version alignment	Same major version on Managed and SaaS recommended
IAM policy	<code>upgrade-assistant:environments:write</code> assigned to migration users

Requirement	Detail
Token scopes	Read network zones , Write network zones , Capture request data

5.2 Installation Steps

Step	Action
1	Open the Dynatrace Hub in your SaaS tenant
2	Search for "SaaS Upgrade Assistant"
3	Install the app
4	Grant the required IAM policy to migration users
5	Open the app and follow the connection wizard

5.3 Connect to Managed Source

Step	Action
1	In the SaaS Upgrade Assistant, select "Connect Source Environment"
2	Enter your Managed cluster URL and environment ID
3	Provide an API token from the Managed environment with Read configuration scope
4	Test the connection
5	Run the initial configuration scan

5.4 Verify Connection

After connecting, the SaaS Upgrade Assistant should display:

Item	Expected
Connection status	Connected (green)
Configuration count	Total number of exportable configurations

Item	Expected
Environment name	Your Managed environment name
Version	Managed cluster version

Tip: Run the initial scan now but do **not** deploy any configurations yet. Configuration migration happens in Step 5. The goal here is to verify the connection works and review the scope of what will be migrated.

5.5 Review Configuration Scope

The SaaS Upgrade Assistant groups configurations by type. Review the counts to validate against your Discovery inventory from Step 1:

Configuration Type	Expected Count (from Step 1)	SUA Count	Match?
Management zones			[]
Auto-tagging rules			[]
Dashboards			[]
Alerting profiles			[]
Request attributes			[]
Service detection rules			[]
SLOs			[]

6. Network Zone Recreation

Network zones do **not** transfer from Managed to SaaS. You must recreate them in the SaaS tenant before migrating any OneAgents.

6.1 Why Zones Must Be Recreated

Reason	Detail
Separate tenants	Managed and SaaS are independent environments
Zone IDs differ	SaaS generates new internal IDs
AG assignment	New SaaS AGs must be assigned to SaaS zones
OneAgent routing	Agents need zones defined before they can route correctly

6.2 Create Zones in SaaS

Recreate each zone from your Design step. Use the Settings UI or API:

Via Settings UI:

Settings > Network zones > Add network zone

Via API:

```
# Create a network zone
curl -X POST "https://{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com/api/v2/networkZones" \
-H "Authorization: Api-Token {token}" \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-d '{
  "id": "datacenter-east",
  "description": "Primary datacenter in East region",
  "alternativeZones": ["datacenter-west"]
}'
```

6.3 Assign ActiveGates to Zones

If you deployed AGs with `--set-network-zone` during installation (Section 4), they are already assigned. Otherwise, update the assignment:

```
# Update AG network zone after installation
# Edit /var/lib/dynatrace/gateway/config/custom.properties
# Add: networkzone = datacenter-east
sudo systemctl restart dynatracegateway
```

6.4 Verify Zone Topology

```
// Verify network zone configuration and AG assignment
fetch dt.entity.active_gate
| fieldsAdd entity.name, zone = networkZone
| fields entity.name, zone
| sort zone asc, entity.name asc

// Note: smartscapeNodes ACTIVE_GATE is not yet available on Grail
// Continue using fetch dt.entity.active_gate until Smartscape coverage
expands
```

6.5 Zone Topology Validation

Compare the SaaS zone topology against your Design step:

Zone Name	Alternative Zone	AGs Assigned	Matches Design?
			[]
			[]
			[]
			[]

Important: Every network zone must have at least 2 ActiveGates for high availability. Verify this before proceeding.

7. Configuration Freeze

Announce and enforce a configuration freeze on the Managed environment. This prevents configuration drift between the source (Managed) and target (SaaS) during migration.

7.1 What to Freeze

Category	Freeze Scope
Dashboards	No new dashboards or modifications to existing ones
Alerting	No new alerting profiles, metric events, or notification rules
Settings	No changes to management zones, auto-tagging, or service detection
Monitoring config	No changes to OneAgent features, deep monitoring, or anomaly detection
RUM/Mobile	No new web or mobile application definitions

7.2 Exception Process

Some changes may be unavoidable during the freeze period:

Exception Type	Approval Required	Documentation
Critical fix	Migration lead	Document change and apply to both Managed and SaaS
Security patch	Security team + Migration lead	Apply to both environments
New deployment	Migration lead	Ensure monitoring config exists in both environments

7.3 Communication Template

Send to all Dynatrace users and configuration owners:

Subject: Dynatrace Configuration Freeze — Effective {date}

As part of the Managed-to-SaaS migration, a configuration freeze is now in effect on the Managed environment. **Do not create or modify** dashboards, alerting rules, management zones, or any other configuration in the Managed tenant.

All configuration changes during this period require approval from the migration lead. Contact {migration-lead-email} for exception requests.

The freeze will remain in effect until the migration is complete (estimated {end-date}).

7.4 Freeze Verification

Monitor for unauthorized changes during the freeze period:

```
// Monitor for configuration changes during freeze period
// Run this on the Managed environment to detect unauthorized changes
fetch events, from:-24h
| filter event.kind == "CONFIG"
| fields timestamp, event.type, user = dt.user, description =
event.description
| sort timestamp desc
| limit 50
```

8. Rollback Procedure

Before executing the migration, document and test a rollback procedure. If issues arise during Step 5, you need to be able to revert OneAgents back to Managed quickly.

8.1 Rollback Approach

Rollback redirects OneAgents from the SaaS tenant back to the Managed environment:

Component	Rollback Action
OneAgent	Redirect to Managed server URL
ActiveGate	No change needed (Managed AGs still running during dual-run)
Configuration	No change needed (Managed config is frozen, not deleted)
Data	Managed retains all historical data until decommissioned

8.2 OneAgent Rollback Command

The key rollback command redirects the OneAgent back to Managed:

```
# Linux rollback
sudo /opt/dynatrace/oneagent/agent/tools/oneagentctl \
  --set-server="https://{managed-cluster}/communication"

# Windows rollback
"C:\Program Files\dynatrace\oneagent\agent\tools\oneagentctl.exe" \
  --set-server="https://{managed-cluster}/communication"
```

8.3 Pre-Migration Rollback Test

Test rollback on a non-production host **before** the production migration:

Step	Action	Validation
1	Select a non-production host currently reporting to Managed	Host visible in Managed UI
2	Redirect OneAgent to SaaS: <code>oneagentctl --set-server="https://{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com/communication"</code>	Host appears in SaaS UI within 5 minutes
3	Verify monitoring data flows to SaaS	Metrics, logs, spans visible in SaaS
4	Execute rollback: <code>oneagentctl --set-server="https://{managed-cluster}/communication"</code>	Host reappears in Managed UI
5	Verify monitoring data resumes in Managed	Metrics, logs, spans visible in Managed

Important: Do not proceed to Step 5 until you have successfully tested rollback on at least one host. This validates that the Managed environment is still fully operational and ready to accept agents back if needed.

8.4 Document Rollback Details

Record these values for use during migration:

Parameter	Value
Managed server URL	<code>https://{managed-cluster}/communication</code>
Managed tenant token	(retrieve from Managed UI > Deployment > OneAgent)
SaaS server URL	<code>https://{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com/communication</code>
SaaS tenant token	(retrieve from SaaS UI > Deployment > OneAgent)
Rollback tested on	{hostname}, {date}
Rollback time	~5 minutes for agent to reconnect

9. Readiness Checklist

Complete every checkpoint before proceeding to Step 5 (Execute). Each item corresponds to a section in this notebook.

Licensing

Checkpoint	Status
Dual-run licensing confirmed with Dynatrace account team	☐
DPS consumption model understood and budgeted	☐
Migration timeline communicated to account team	☐

SaaS Tenant

Checkpoint	Status
SaaS tenant provisioned in correct data residency region	☐
Tenant accessible at <code>{tenant-id}.live.dynatrace.com</code>	☐
Tenant accessible at <code>{tenant-id}.apps.dynatrace.com</code>	☐
Baseline settings configured (timezone, currency, retention)	☐
API access verified	☐

SSO and Identity

Checkpoint	Status
SAML SSO configured and tested	☐
IdP signs full SAML message (not just assertion)	☐
Azure Entra group claims filtered (if applicable)	☐
DNS domain validated	☐
Initial IAM groups and policies created	☐
SSO tested with users from each IAM group	☐

ActiveGates

Checkpoint	Status
New SaaS-connected AGs deployed per Design step sizing	☐
Each AG assigned to correct network zone	☐
Minimum 2 AGs per network zone for HA	☐
AG groups created (routing, extensions, synthetic)	☐
AG connectivity to SaaS validated	☐
AG health confirmed in Dynatrace UI	☐

SaaS Upgrade Assistant

Checkpoint	Status
App installed in SaaS tenant	☐
<code>upgrade-assistant:environments:write</code> IAM policy granted	☐
Connected to Managed source environment	☐
Initial configuration scan completed	☐
Configuration counts match Discovery inventory	☐

Network Zones

Checkpoint	Status
All zones recreated in SaaS	[]
Alternative zones configured for failover	[]
AGs assigned to correct zones	[]
Zone topology matches Design step	[]

Configuration Freeze

Checkpoint	Status
Configuration freeze announced to all stakeholders	[]
Exception process documented and communicated	[]
Monitoring for unauthorized changes in place	[]

Rollback

Checkpoint	Status
Managed server URL and tenant token documented	[]
SaaS server URL and tenant token documented	[]
Rollback procedure documented	[]
Rollback tested on non-production host	[]
Rollback test successful (agent reconnected to Managed)	[]

Communication

Checkpoint	Status
Migration schedule communicated to stakeholders	[]
Support team briefed on rollback procedure	[]

Checkpoint	Status
Escalation contacts identified for migration window	[]

Next Step

→ **M2S-05: Step 5 — Execute** — Migrate configurations using the SaaS Upgrade Assistant and redirect OneAgents from Managed to SaaS.

Continue the Series

Next Notebook	Focus
M2S-05: Step 5 — Execute	Configuration migration and agent redirection

Preparation Resources

- [SaaS Upgrade Assistant Documentation](#)
- [SaaS Upgrade Assistant on Dynatrace Hub](#)
- [ActiveGate Installation](#)
- [Network Zones Configuration](#)
- [SAML SSO Setup](#)
- [IAM Documentation](#)
- [OneAgent Communication](#)
- [Azure Native Dynatrace Service](#)

Summary

In this notebook, you prepared:

- **Licensing** — Dual-run licensing coordinated with Dynatrace account team for the overlap period
- **SaaS tenant** — Provisioned in the correct data residency region with baseline configuration
- **SSO and identity** — SAML 2.0 configured, DNS domain validated, initial IAM groups created
- **ActiveGates** — New SaaS-connected AGs deployed in parallel, assigned to network zones
- **SaaS Upgrade Assistant** — Installed, connected to Managed, initial scan completed
- **Network zones** — All zones recreated in SaaS matching the Design step topology
- **Configuration freeze** — Announced and enforced on the Managed environment
- **Rollback** — Procedure documented and tested on a non-production host

Key Takeaway: Preparation is the most critical step in a smooth migration. Every item in the readiness checklist reduces risk during execution. Do not proceed to Step 5 until every checkbox is complete—especially the rollback test. A tested rollback gives confidence to move forward.

Continue to M2S-05: Step 5 — Execute to begin migrating configurations and redirecting agents.

This notebook was AI-generated from community-submitted and publicly available sources. This notebook series is not officially supported by Dynatrace. Always verify information against official Dynatrace documentation.